

Alicia Nicolás Pedro

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QA Manager | Quality Engineering Manager | QA Governance | Test Strategy | Banking | Fintech | Agile

QA Manager with over **20 years of experience leading Quality Assurance strategies** across banking, fintech, retail, telecommunications, and public sector organizations. Specialist in **QA Strategy, QA Governance, Quality Engineering, Test Management, test automation, CI/CD integration, and Agile/Scrum methodologies**, as well as **Waterfall, BPM, and Risk-Based Process Management (RBPM)**.

Proven experience leading multidisciplinary teams, defining quality frameworks, managing risks, establishing executive KPIs, and ensuring the delivery of high-quality software in complex digital transformation programs.

Led QA initiatives for organizations such as **BBVA, Santander, HSBC, Scotiabank, SAT, IBM, HP, Deloitte, PepsiCo, Grupo Bimbo, Ford, Liverpool, CONAGUA, Novartis, and Nextel**, contributing to production incident reduction, increased test coverage, process optimization, and continuous improvement of software release cycles.

Skills

QA Leadership & Strategy: QA Strategy & Governance • Test Management • Stakeholder Management • Risk & Release Management • Quality Process Improvement • Test Planning • Defect Prevention • Root Cause Analysis • Shift-Left Testing • Continuous Improvement.

Testing: Functional Testing • Regression Testing • Integration Testing • User Acceptance Testing (UAT) • API Testing • Performance Testing • Static Testing • Validation Data

Automation & DevOps: Test Automation Strategy • Selenium WebDriver • Cucumber • CI/CD Integration

Quality Engineering: Defect Lifecycle Management • QA Metrics & Reporting • Continuous Improvement.

Methodologies: CMMI • TMMI • BPM • RBPM • Scrum • Agile • Waterfall.

Tools

Test & Project Management : Jira • Azure DevOps (TFS) • ALM / Quality Center • IBM ClearQuest • IBM Rational Suite

Automation: Selenium WebDriver • Cucumber • CI/CD

API Testing: Postman

Performance: JMeter • LoadRunner

Data Bases: SQL Server • Oracle • PostgreSQL • MySQL • Data Warehouse • Toad • DBVisualizer

Modeling & Design: UML • Visio • Figma

Others tools: Linux • Android Studio • Xcode • Vysor

Professional Experience

Pacto Technology Mexico | QA Manager | Nov 2024 – April 2026

- Defined and implemented the end-to-end QA strategy for Web, Android, and SmartPOS solutions.
- Reduced production incidents by up to **98%** through preventive QA controls and improved validation processes.
- Increased test coverage for critical business processes and improved release stability.
- Integrated automated testing into CI/CD pipelines, reducing validation time and accelerating release cycles.
- Implemented executive dashboards and KPIs for quality monitoring.
- Defined QA strategy for AI-driven digitalization initiatives, validating OCR processes and financial credit solutions.

Publicis Groupe/Digitas | QA Manager | March 2023 – Nov 2024

- Led QA strategy for Web and mobile applications for PepsiCo.
- Improved mobile application stability through functional, integration, and performance testing strategies.
- Managed production incidents using Firebase Crashlytics, including root cause analysis, defect prioritization, and validation of fixes for iOS and Android applications.
- Led functional testing, UAT, and validation activities with cross-functional teams.
- Implemented QA KPIs dashboards at squad and organizational level.
- Collaborated with UX/UI teams to standardize application usability.
- Coordinated validation activities with external vendors and client teams prior to production release.
- Validated AI-based OCR solutions, ensuring correct functionality and integration with mobile applications.
- Defined quality controls for fraud detection, multi-account user identification, SLA compliance, and participation policy validation.

Ondore/Atomic32 | Coordinador QA | August 2013 – March 2023

Clients: Bankaool, Banco BASE, Consubanco, Switch (payments services), Blocks (crypto trading), OndoreScout

- Led QA strategy for banking, financial, and blockchain platforms.
- Implemented test automation using Selenium and API validation using Postman.
- Led testing efforts for digital banking, SME loan applications, payment systems, and blockchain solutions.
- Managed defects, QA metrics, and process improvements under Scrum methodologies.
- Coordinated 4 to 5 concurrent projects, managing QA activities, risks, and delivery timelines.

Test Lead | Test Manager | QA Specialist | 2007 – 2013

Clients: HSBC, Scotiabank, IBM, HP, SAT, Deloitte, Ford, PepsiCo, Nextel

- Led QA teams of up to **15 specialists in Mexico and 4 remote collaborators in Colombia**.
- Managed up to **three concurrent strategic projects** in banking and government sectors.
- Defined test strategies, effort estimation, resource planning, and risk management.
- Led SIT and UAT execution, test automation, and QA process improvements.

QA Analyst | Test Engineer | 2003 – 2007

Companies: Softtek, Getronics

- Performed functional, regression, integration, and early automation testing.
- Designed and executed test cases for enterprise applications.
- Supported validation activities for clients including Liverpool, CONAGUA, Novartis, and Nextel.

Education

Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science

Instituto Politécnico Nacional (IPN) – UPIICSA

2000 – 2004

Languages

Spanish: Native

English: Intermediate (B1)

Reading and writing technical documentation, emails, and reports. Ability to understand technical meetings. Speaking skills in development.